

Is This Still Serving the Calling?

1 / Why are we doing this?

Pastor, you do not have to carry this conversation alone or arrive with every answer. Bring the people who do the work and the people affected by it. With Scripture open and the Holy Spirit leading, ask honestly what should continue, what needs care, and what needs to change.

Ministry / process / system: _____

Church: _____ Date: _____

People in this conversation: _____

What we examine	Questions worth asking	What we are seeing
Purpose	Why does this exist? What biblical responsibility or real need is it serving?	_____ _____
Vision	What do we hope will be different in people's lives because of this?	_____ _____
Mission	How does this help us practice our mission - not just repeat our mission statement?	_____ _____
Christ at the center	Does the way we do this reflect Jesus' character and methods? What in Scripture supports - or challenges - our approach?	_____ _____
Fruit	What is actually happening? What have the people involved experienced, beyond attendance or activity?	_____ _____
Honest examination	If we were starting today, would we build it this way? Why?	_____ _____
Hidden cost	Who is carrying more than we realize? What does this require in time, money, relationships, and strength?	_____ _____
Hard conversations	What concern have we avoided naming? What makes it difficult to talk about?	_____ _____

Choose one ministry, process, or system to examine at a time.

Is it life giving?

2 / Look at the people this touches.

Systems do not create life. Jesus does. Healthy systems make room for the life He is already growing.

Ministry / process / system: _____

Who it touches	Life and fruit	Cost and strain	Needed changes
The Pastor Does this support faithful, shared leadership - or depend on the Pastor continually rescuing it?			
The congregation Are people being formed, equipped, and entrusted - or repeatedly asked to fill gaps?			
The community Have we listened to the people we hope to serve? Are we responding to their actual needs?			
The world through missions How does our church's ministry cultivate prayer, generosity, partnership, and faithful service beyond our community?			

Life-giving does not mean effortless. Slow or costly ministry is not automatically failing.

Every system does not need to serve all four directions equally. Consider its particular calling, and the church's ministry as a whole.

What will we do next?

3 / Choose a faithful next step.

With Scripture open and the Holy Spirit leading, decide together what should change and how you will carry it. Choose one step you can put into practice and review.

Ministry / process / system: _____

- ☐ Strengthen
- ☐ Share
- ☐ Simplify
- ☐ Redesign
- ☐ Pause
- ☐ Release

What did we decide, and why?	_____
What is our one next faithful step?	_____ _____
Who will carry it?	_____
What authority, training, resources, and support will they need?	_____ _____
What biblical responsibility must remain, even if we change how we carry it?	_____ _____
Who needs to be heard before we act?	_____ _____
How will we know it is helping? Notice both fruit and cost. Listen to the people involved.	_____ _____
When will we review it, and who will be there?	_____

You do not have to repair every system at once. Begin with what needs your attention, support the people carrying it, and return to learn together.